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00 - PROPOSED RESOLUTION *Recognition of "RotaKids" as an Authorized District-Led Rotary Family Youth Program* - The core legislative instrument submitted to the Council on Resolutions (the single document that delegates are asked to vote on).

VOLUME I - CORE DOCUMENTS

Table of Contents This document - a structured guide to the complete 2026 RotaKids Resolution Package and its components.

01 - Standard RotaKids Club Constitution The foundational governance document defining the club's name, purpose, age framework, leadership structure, and relationship with the sponsoring Rotary Club and District.

02 - Standard RotaKids Club Bylaws* The operational rulebook covering elections, officer duties, meetings, finances, the Gear of Service merit system, safeguarding provisions, and the amendment process.

03 - RotaKids Statement of Policy *(Proposed Amendment to the Rotary Code of Policies - Article 13)* The legal text proposed for adoption into RI's Code of Policies, establishing the global framework for RotaKids certification, branding, membership, and transition to Interact.

04 - RotaKids Guide for Rotary Club Sponsors A practical guide for sponsoring Rotary Clubs explaining the two organizational models, the five-step launch process, the zero-fee funding philosophy, and the available digital infrastructure.

05 - The RotaKids Global Handbook for Teachers and Mentors The pedagogical core of the program: meeting structure, the Service-Learning methodology, implementation of the Gear of Service, the RotaKids Citation criteria, and the Bridge to Interact transition protocol.

06 - RotaKids Branding & Merit Guide Visual identity specifications, logo usage rules, the Three Wheels philosophical framework, physical badge production guidelines, and brand protection standards.

07 - District-Led Safeguarding & Child Protection Framework The decentralized accountability model that keeps legal liability entirely at District level, with safety protocols, data protection rules, incident reporting procedures, and adult screening standards.

08 - The 2026 Resolution Position Paper The strategic case for adoption: a decade of rejected resolutions analyzed, global statistics documented, RI's key concerns addressed, the RAG precedent invoked, and the three-year pilot framework proposed.

** Note: The Standard RotaKids Club Bylaws (Document 02) establish the global governance framework applicable to all RotaKids clubs worldwide. Individual districts and clubs are encouraged to develop supplementary internal regulations adapted to the specific legal requirements, educational policies, and child protection legislation of their jurisdiction. Such internal regulations must be consistent with the Standard RotaKids Club Constitution and Bylaws and are subject to approval by the sponsoring Rotary Club Board of Directors.*

VOLUME II - ANNEXES

09 - Annex A: Visual Identity Style Guide Complete graphic standards for the RotaKids brand, including logo variations, official color specifications, typography, badge design templates, and uniform guidelines. *(Separate volume due to graphic content.)*

10 - Annex B: RotaKids in Action - A Global Project Showcase Regional maps showing the global distribution of verified clubs, followed by 70 documented project examples across 7 categories and 25+ countries - the human evidence behind the resolution.

VOLUME III - EDITABLE FORMS & OFFICIAL DOCUMENTS

Official templates for club administration, member recognition, and program governance. Upon adoption of this resolution, editable PDF templates for all documents listed in this section will be made available for download on rotakids.org. Districts are encouraged to translate these templates into their local language; all translated versions will be required to be submitted to rotakids.org for publication, ensuring that the global RotaKids community benefits from every localization effort.

CLUB ADMINISTRATION

11 - *RotaKids Club Charter / Certificate of Organization* The official chartering document presented to a newly certified RotaKids club, signed by the District Governor or District RotaKids Committee Chair and the sponsoring Rotary Club President or, where applicable, the President of the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club. To be displayed in the club's meeting location.

11.1 - *Club Charter Application / Certification Form* The form submitted by the sponsoring Rotary Club to the District, initiating the official chartering process for a new RotaKids club. Requires signatures from the sponsoring Rotary Club President, or where applicable the President of the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club, and the District Governor or District RotaKids Committee Chair.

12 - *Member Registration Form* Individual membership registration form completed by the parent or legal guardian of each new RotaKids member, including personal data, emergency contacts, and consent for participation in club activities.

13 - *Parental Consent Form* Standalone consent document completed by the parent or legal guardian for specific activities, events, off-site visits, digital platform access, and photography or publication permissions. To be completed separately for each activity requiring explicit parental authorization.

14 - *Annual Club Report Form* Annual activity report submitted by the Rotarian Advisor to the District RotaKids Committee at the end of each Rotary year, documenting meetings held, projects completed, membership numbers, Gear of Service advancement, and Citation eligibility.

CLUB & PROGRAM RECOGNITION

15 - *RotaKids Club Citation Certificate* The annual performance recognition certificate awarded to clubs that achieve a minimum of 5 out of 7 Citation criteria during a Rotary year, issued by the District Governor or District RotaKids Committee Chair.

15.1 - *RotaKids Club Citation Application Form* The form submitted by the sponsoring Rotary Club President or, where applicable, the President of the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club, to the District RotaKids Committee Chair, documenting the club's achievement of the Citation criteria and requesting formal recognition.
16 - *Jane Mills Award Certificate* The highest individual service recognition in the RotaKids program, awarded by the District Governor to Rotarians and non-Rotarians alike who have made an extraordinary and sustained contribution to RotaKids. Named in honor of Jane M. Mills, founder of the world's first RotaKids club at Jensen Beach School, Florida, USA.
16.1 - *Jane Mills Award Nomination Form* The nomination form submitted by a RotaKids club or sponsoring Rotary Club to the District RotaKids Committee, initiating the award process. Requires endorsement from the sponsoring Rotary Club President or, where applicable, the President of the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club, and approval from the District Governor. A maximum of three awards may be granted per district per Rotary year.
17 - *RotaKids Fellow Certificate* The financial contribution recognition certificate awarded to individuals, organizations, or corporations that donate to a local RotaKids club or District RotaKids Fund, at three levels: RotaKids Fellow ($500), RotaKids Fellow+ ($1,000), and Master Gear Fellow ($2,500+). All donations are directed exclusively to the local RotaKids club or District RotaKids Fund, consistent with the RotaKids District-Led model.
Note: This is an adult donor recognition program for sponsors of the District Fund / Rotary Club sponsor / RotaKids Club, not a membership fee or title for children. RotaKids membership remains strictly zero-cost for the child.
17.1 - *RotaKids Fellow Application Form* The form submitted by the sponsoring Rotary Club or District RotaKids Committee documenting the donation and requesting the appropriate level of recognition for the contributor.

MEMBER RECOGNITION - THE GEAR OF SERVICE
18 - *Welcome & Level I Induction Certificate* Presented to every child upon joining a RotaKids club, marking their entry into the program and automatic enrollment at Level I - The Solid Wheel ("TO BE / Belonging"). The first document a RotaKid receives and the beginning of their personal journey.
19 - *Level II Induction Certificate* Presented upon advancement to Level II - The Spoked Wheel ("TO DO / Direction") - marking the transition from belonging to active contribution. Accompanied by the formal presentation of the new badge reflecting advancement to Level II.
20 - *Level III Induction Certificate* Presented upon advancement to Level III - The Cogwheel ("TO MULTIPLY / Leadership") - marking the transition to leadership and the capacity to inspire others. Accompanied by the formal presentation of the new badge reflecting advancement to Level III.
21 - *Master of the Gear Certificate* The highest individual member recognition, presented upon full completion of Level III. Serves as the formal letter of recommendation for

entry into an Interact club, recognizing the member as a fully developed young leader within the Rotary family.

22 – *RotaKids Graduation Certificate* Presented to every member upon leaving the RotaKids programme, regardless of the level reached at the time of departure. Documents the member's years of service, projects completed, and Gear of Service level achieved. This is the "passport" that accompanies every RotaKid into their next chapter - whether Interact, school leadership, or community life.

OFFICER RECOGNITION

23 - *Officer Certificate - President* Presented upon election to the office of President of the RotaKids Club, recognizing the member's leadership role and the responsibilities assumed under the Standard RotaKids Club Constitution.

24 - *Officer Certificate - Vice-President* Presented upon election to the office of Vice-President, recognizing the member's supporting leadership role and their responsibility to assume the duties of any absent officer.

25 - *Officer Certificate - Secretary* Presented upon election to the office of Secretary, recognizing the member's responsibility for attendance records, meeting notes, and the Three Wheels Register of volunteer service hours.

26 - *Officer Certificate - Treasurer* Presented upon election to the office of Treasurer, recognizing the member's responsibility for the club's funds and financial reporting to the Board and the sponsoring Rotary Club.

Resolution Package submitted by: Adrian Stan, Past District 2241 RotaKids Committee Chair (2014–2018), Rotary Club of Pitesti, District 2241 - Romania & Republic of Moldova; Digital infrastructure: rotakids.net / rotakids.org / rotakids.com / rotakids.club & rotarykids.com / rotarykids.org / rotarykids.net.

STANDARD ROTAKIDS CLUB CONSTITUTION

Article 1 – Name

The name of this organization shall be the RotaKids Club of [Name of School/Community], sponsored by the Rotary Club of [Name of Sponsor Club], or by two or more sponsoring Rotary Clubs where a co-sponsorship model has been approved by the District. This club shall operate as an authorized district-led Rotary family youth program, established for children aged 7 to 12, with a one-year extension in either direction permitted upon approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with applicable local law. For informal and abbreviated use, the club may be referred to as RK [Name of School/Community] or [Name of School/Community] RK, consistent with the convention used within the Rotary family for sponsored clubs.

Article 2 - Object of RotaKids

The object of RotaKids is to introduce young children to the ideal of Service Above Self through activity-based learning. The club seeks to help children:

1. Develop leadership skills through community service.
2. Understand the value of ethical behavior through the RotaKids Pledge.
3. Foster international understanding and respect for others.
4. Bridge the transition into Interact (ages 12-18).

Article 3 - Sponsorship and Governance

1. Sponsorship: This club is organized and sponsored by the Rotary Club of [Name of Sponsor Club], or by two or more co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs where approved by the District. The sponsoring Rotary Club, or the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club in a co-sponsorship model, exercises supervision and control over all activities, policies, and constitutional matters of the RotaKids club.
2. Multiple Club Sponsorship: A Rotary Club may sponsor more than one RotaKids club, and two or more Rotary Clubs may jointly sponsor one or more RotaKids clubs, provided that the District approves the arrangement and that one lead sponsoring Rotary Club is designated for certification, reporting, safeguarding coordination, and communication with the District.
3. Dual Models of Governance:

   A. School-Based: In a school-based club, day-to-day safeguarding and child protection procedures are administered by the educational institution under its existing policies and under a formal agreement with the sponsoring Rotary club. The sponsoring Rotary club remains responsible for ensuring that such agreement, adult supervision, parental consent, and local legal compliance are in place.

B. Community-Based: In a community-based club, responsibility for safeguarding, financial management, insurance, supervision, and legal compliance rests with the sponsoring Rotary club and District, in compliance with local District regulations and national laws.

4. District Authority: The District Governor and the District RotaKids Committee Chair have final authority over the certification and continued operation of RotaKids clubs within the District.

Article 4 – Membership

1. Eligibility: Membership shall be open to children residing or studying within the community served by the sponsoring Rotary club who wish to participate in service-learning activities and whose participation is approved by a parent or legal guardian.
2. Age Limits: Membership is open to children typically aged 7 to 12. With the approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with local law, membership may be extended to children aged 6, or continued until the end of the Rotary year in which the member turns 13. Members approaching the upper age limit are encouraged to transition into an Interact club at the end of the Rotary year in which they reach the age of 13, ensuring continuity within the Rotary family.
3. The RotaKids Pledge: Every member shall commit to the following:
   To be fair to all. To serve my community. To show respect for others.

Article 5 - The Gear of Service (Merit System)

The club shall adopt the RotaKids Gear of Service system to recognize the developmental progress of its members. This system is based on certified volunteer hours and leadership competence and is reflected on a single badge format containing two marker systems: three Level Markers and three Progress Markers.

I. Level I: THE SOLID WHEEL - "TO BE" (Belonging) Representing the core unit and belonging to the Rotary family. Recognition: advancement within Level I is reflected through the progressive filling of the three Progress Markers on the badge.

II. Level II: THE SPOKED WHEEL - "TO DO" (Direction) Representing the individual contribution and specific roles within a project. Recognition: advancement to Level II is reflected by the badge version showing Level I completed in the Level Markers area, while progress within Level II is reflected through the progressive filling of the three Progress Markers.

III. Level III: THE COGWHEEL - "TO MULTIPLY" (Leadership) Representing the power to move others and lead community initiatives. Recognition: advancement to Level III is reflected by the badge version showing Levels I and II completed in the Level Markers area, while progress within Level III is reflected through the progressive filling of the three Progress Markers.

The color used to fill the circle markers is at the discretion of the RotaKids club, subject to approval by the sponsoring Rotary Club, consistent with the uniform color guidelines established in Annex A.

Article 6 - Officers and Leadership

The leadership of this club shall consist of a RotaKids Board, including a President, Vice-President, Secretary, and Treasurer. All officers shall be elected by the members and supervised by a Rotarian Advisor and/or a Faculty Advisor. To be eligible for the office of President, a member must have completed at least one full year of active membership in the club, or hold at minimum the Level II (Spoked Wheel) award of the Gear of Service recognition system.

Article 7 – Meetings

1. Meetings shall be held at least once per month at a time and place suited to the school or community environment.
2. A quorum for any meeting shall be a majority of the active membership.
3. The Rotarian Advisor shall attend all meetings of a community-based club. In the case of a school-based club, the Rotarian Advisor is required to attend at minimum the monthly board meetings; regular membership meetings shall be supervised by the Faculty Advisor.

Article 8 - Fees and Dues

1. RI Dues: There shall be no fees or dues payable by this club or its members to Rotary International.
2. District Dues: There shall be no fees or dues payable to the District. Funding for activities shall be provided by the sponsoring Rotary club, voluntary donations, or service-learning fundraising projects organized by the RotaKids members.

Article 9 - Relationship with Rotary International

This club is not a member of Rotary International but is recognized as a part of the Rotary family through its charter with the sponsoring Rotary club and the District. Rotary International authorizes the use of the RotaKids name, official logo, and programme framework under the recognized district-led model, but assumes no legal, financial, safeguarding, or operational liability for the club's activities.

STANDARD ROTAKIDS CLUB BYLAWS

Article 1 – Definitions

1. Board: The governing council of the RotaKids Club.
2. Director: A member of the Board.
3. Member: A child aged 7 to 12, officially registered with the club, or aged 6 to 13 where a one-year extension has been approved by the sponsoring Rotary Club in accordance with applicable local law.
4. Quorum: The minimum number of members required to be present in order to vote on a decision (50% + 1).
5. Sponsor: The Rotary Club that granted the Charter, or, in a co-sponsorship model approved by the District, the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club acting on behalf of all co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs.
6. Rotarian Advisor: A member of the sponsoring Rotary Club, or of one of the co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs, designated to guide, support and supervise the RotaKids Club.
7. Faculty Advisor: A teacher or school staff member designated by the school administration to supervise the club's day-to-day activities in a school-based setting.
8. Co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs: Two or more Rotary Clubs approved by the District to jointly sponsor one or more RotaKids clubs. In such cases, one lead sponsoring Rotary Club shall be designated for certification, reporting, safeguarding coordination, financial oversight, and communication with the District. For the purposes of these Bylaws, references to the sponsoring Rotary Club include the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club in an approved co-sponsorship model, unless the context requires otherwise.

Article 2 - Elections and Terms of Office

1. Elections for the offices of President, Vice-President, Secretary, and Treasurer shall be held annually, preferably in May, so that the term of office begins on 1 July, coinciding with the Rotary year.
2. The term of office for any officer is one year. Re-election is permitted provided the age limit has not been exceeded.
3. Voting shall be conducted by secret ballot, under the supervision of the Advisor.

Article 3 - Duties of Officers

1. President: Chairs meetings, proposes project ideas, and maintains communication with the sponsoring Rotary Club or, where applicable, the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club.

2. Vice-President: Assists the President and assumes the duties of any absent officer, including those of President, Secretary, or Treasurer, as required.
3. Secretary: Maintains attendance records, takes notes during meetings, and manages the "Three Wheels Register" (volunteer service hours log).
4. Treasurer: Manages the club's small funds (from bake sales or donations) and presents the expenditure report to the Board and the sponsoring Rotary Club or, where applicable, the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club.

Article 4 – Meetings

1. The club shall meet at least once per month.
2. Meetings may be held on school premises (School-Based Model) or at a location designated by the sponsoring Rotary Club (Community-Based Model).
3. No meeting shall be deemed official unless the Rotarian Advisor is present (Community-Based Model) or the Faculty Advisor is present (School-Based Model).
4. Every meeting shall begin with the RotaKids Pledge.

Article 5 - Projects and Activities

1. The club is required to complete at least three service projects per year:
    a) One project benefiting the school or local environment.
    b) One project with regional or national impact.
    c) One project dedicated to international understanding (e.g., End Polio Now).
2. All projects shall be identified with the official RotaKids logo, consistent with the visual identity guidelines established in Annex A.

Article 6 - Application of the Merit System (The Gear of Service)

6.1 Badge Structure

The Gear of Service uses a single badge format with two marker systems: three Level Markers positioned at 9 o'clock and three Progress Markers positioned at 3 o'clock.

The Level Markers indicate the member's current Gear of Service level. The Progress Markers indicate the member's progress within the current level.

Upon joining, the member receives the Level I badge version, showing no completed Level Markers and no filled Progress Markers. Upon advancement to Level II, the member receives a new badge version showing Level I completed in the Level Markers area. Upon advancement to Level III, the member receives a new badge version showing Levels I and II completed in the Level Markers area.

The color used to fill the circles is at the discretion of the RotaKids club, subject to approval by the sponsoring Rotary Club, consistent with the uniform color guidelines established in Annex A - Visual Identity Style Guide.

Board officers (President, Vice-President, Secretary, and Treasurer) are identified by a small ribbon attached beneath the standard badge, in the club's uniform color, without text or symbols. The ribbon indicates temporary service responsibility and carries no indication of the specific office held.

6.2 Progression Mechanism

Upon joining the club, the member receives the Level I badge version. Progress within the current level is reflected by filling the three Progress Markers one at a time, at the Wheel Loading Ceremony, as the member accumulates the required volunteer hours and completes the required activities for each marker.

When the third and final Progress Marker of a level is filled, the member receives the Level Completion Certificate for that level at the same ceremony - a moment of celebration shared with the club, the Rotarian Advisor, and invited guests.

The member continues to wear the completed badge until advancement to the next level is formally recognized.

Upon advancement to the next level, the member receives a new badge version corresponding to that new level. The new badge shall show the previously completed level in the Level Markers area and shall already include the first filled Progress Marker of the new current level.

This mechanism ensures continuity of visible progression within the Gear of Service system and preserves the distinction between completed levels and active progress within the current level.

The previous badge belongs permanently to the member and is taken home as a personal record of service.

6.3 Simultaneous Wearing

At any given time, the member wears the current badge corresponding to their present Gear of Service level and progress status.

Where applicable, a Board ribbon may be attached beneath that badge for the duration of the member's term of office.

Members may choose to wear any or all of their earned badges simultaneously, as a visible record of their complete journey through the Gear of Service. There is no obligation to wear all badges; the choice is entirely personal. What matters is that every badge earned belongs permanently to the member, as a tangible record of service that no one can take away.

6.4 Wheel Loading Ceremony

The physical filling of circles on the badge - the Wheel Loading Ceremony - shall take place at a formal club meeting, by the highest-ranking available officer from the following order of precedence:

1. President of the sponsoring Rotary Club
2. Vice-President of the sponsoring Rotary Club
3. Rotarian Advisor
4. School Principal *(school-based clubs only)*
5. Faculty Advisor
6. President or Vice-President of the RotaKids Club *(in the absence of all of the above)*

Progress Markers are filled from top to bottom as viewed from the front of the badge, with the bottommost Progress Marker filled last - the most prominent point, always the final achievement earned within the current level.

When a member advances to a new Gear of Service level, the new badge version shall be presented formally at the same ceremony or at the next suitable formal meeting, together with the corresponding Level Completion Certificate for the level just completed.

6.5 District Discretion

The number of volunteer hours or activities required to earn each circle is not mandated globally. Each District RotaKids Committee shall establish the minimum requirements applicable within its jurisdiction, consistent with local educational standards and the age group of the members. These requirements shall be documented in the District's supplementary internal regulations and communicated clearly to all sponsoring clubs

Article 7 - Finances

1. Membership dues shall not be mandatory. No child may be required or expected to contribute financially. Voluntary family, community, or sponsor donations may be accepted only through the sponsoring Rotary Club or another locally approved transparent mechanism.
2. All funds raised through Service-Learning projects must be deposited in a dedicated account or managed transparently through the treasury of the sponsoring Rotary Club.
3. Funds may be used exclusively for charitable causes or the purchase of materials required for projects (e.g., plants, paint, badges).

Article 8 - Safeguarding of Minors

1. All club activities shall be conducted under the supervision of a designated adult, as follows:
   a) School-based clubs: the Faculty Advisor, or any other adult approved by the school administration, in accordance with the school's child protection policies.
   b) Community-based clubs: the Rotarian Advisor designated by the sponsoring Rotary Club.

   In all cases, the sponsoring Rotary Club bears responsibility for ensuring that appropriate adult supervision, written agreements, parental consent where required, and local legal compliance are in place for every RotaKids activity.
2. The use of digital platforms by RotaKids members is prohibited without the supervision of the Rotarian Advisor or Faculty Advisor, and the written consent of parents or guardians.
3. The website provided through *rotakids.club* shall be administered by an adult designated by the sponsoring Rotary Club (New Generation Officer).

Article 9 - Adoption and Amendments

These Bylaws may be amended by a vote of two-thirds (2/3) of the club's members; however, any amendment shall become valid only upon written approval by the Board of Directors of the sponsoring Rotary Club or, in an approved co-sponsorship model, by the Board of Directors of the designated lead sponsoring Rotary Club.

ROTAKIDS STATEMENT OF POLICY

13.010. Purpose of RotaKids

RotaKids is an authorized district-led Rotary family youth program for children aged 7 to 12, with a one-year extension in either direction permitted upon approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with applicable local law. The purpose of the program is to introduce children to the concept of Service Above Self, foster the development of leadership skills, encourage ethical behavior through the application of the RotaKids Pledge.

13.020. District-Led Governance Model

Unlike centrally managed programs, RotaKids operates under a District-led model.

1. Authorization: The RI Board authorizes the use of the RotaKids brand name and logo by Rotary districts worldwide.
2. Liability: Rotary International assumes no legal or financial liability for the activities of RotaKids clubs. The responsibility for safeguarding, insurance, operational supervision, and legal compliance rests with the sponsoring Rotary Club and the respective District, in accordance with applicable local law and any formal agreement with a host school or community partner.
3. Certification: The District Governor, or in their absence the Chair of the District RotaKids Committee, is responsible for certifying new clubs and ensuring their adherence to the Standard RotaKids Club Constitution.
4. Sponsorship Models: A RotaKids club may be sponsored by one Rotary Club or co-sponsored by two or more Rotary Clubs, subject to District approval. A Rotary Club or a group of Rotary Clubs may sponsor more than one RotaKids club. In all co-sponsorship arrangements, one lead sponsoring Rotary Club shall be designated for certification, reporting, safeguarding coordination, financial oversight, and communication with the District.

13.030. Membership and Age Limits

1. Membership is open to children aged 7 to 12, with a one-year extension in either direction permitted upon approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with applicable local law.
2. Members approaching the upper age limit are encouraged to transition into an Interact club at the end of the Rotary year in which they reach the age of 13, ensuring continuity within the Rotary family.

13.040. Branding and Visual Identity

1. Official Color: The primary brand color for RotaKids is Turquoise (PMS 7466C / C96 M1 Y31 K0 / Hex #00adbb / R0 G173 B187). This color is mandatory for the official RotaKids logo. For one-color applications, the logo may be reproduced in white, consistent with Rotary International's brand guidelines for one-color use.
2. Promotional Materials: The use of Turquoise is recommended but not mandatory for banners, apparel, and other promotional materials. Clubs and districts are encouraged to maintain visual consistency with the official color.
3. Brand Protection: Upon authorization or recognition by Rotary International, the RotaKids name and official logo shall be treated as protected Rotary programme marks, subject to RI brand rules. No RotaKids club or district shall use the brand in a way that implies a legal partnership with RI beyond the authorized district-led youth program framework.
4. Heritage Logo: The original RotaKids logo, created by Rotary in Great Britain & Ireland, is recognized as the official Heritage Logo of the RotaKids programme. Its use is authorized alongside the Official Logo, in accordance with the visual identity guidelines established in Annex A.

13.050. The Gear of Service (Developmental Framework)

RI recognizes the Gear of Service as the official progression system for RotaKids. This three-level model focuses on personal growth and community service and is reflected on the member's badge through two marker systems: Level Markers and Progress Markers.

I. Level I - The Solid Wheel ("TO BE" / Belonging): Recognition through progressive completion of the Progress Markers while the member is in Level I.
II. Level II - The Spoked Wheel ("TO DO" / Direction): Recognition through formal advancement to the Level II badge version and progressive completion of the Progress Markers within that level.
III. Level III - The Cogwheel ("TO MULTIPLY" / Leadership): Recognition through formal advancement to the Level III badge version and progressive completion of the Progress Markers within that level.

The color used to fill the circle markers is at the discretion of the RotaKids club, subject to approval by the sponsoring Rotary Club, consistent with the uniform color guidelines established in Annex A.
Districts have the authority to define the specific volunteer hour or activity requirements for each Progress Marker, in accordance with local educational and legal frameworks.

13.060. Financial Policy

1. RI Fees: No dues or fees shall be collected by Rotary International from RotaKids clubs or their members.

2. District Funding: Districts and sponsoring clubs shall determine local funding models. RotaKids clubs are encouraged to engage in service-learning fundraising to finance their own projects.

13.070. Digital Infrastructure and Data Privacy

1. To support global coordination, the Rotary community may utilize the RotaKids Global Digital Hub (including *rotakids.net*, *rotakids.org*, *rotakids.com*, and *rotakids.club*), subject to stewardship, governance, privacy, and technical arrangements acceptable to RI and the relevant Districts.
2. Development Status: The RotaKids Global Digital Hub is offered as an existing foundational infrastructure asset. Its current components may include functional documentation pages, manually administered registry tools, prototype interfaces, and placeholder pages. No component shall be treated as an official RI-operated production service unless and until it has passed technical, safeguarding, privacy, and governance review under arrangements acceptable to RI and Districts.
3. Privacy: Districts must ensure that no personal data of minors is shared globally or published without written parental consent. Data storage must comply with local privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR, COPPA).

13.080. Relationship and Transition to Interact

1. RotaKids is recognized as the foundational tier of the Rotary Youth Service pipeline. Members who transition from RotaKids upon reaching the applicable age limit are eligible for Interact membership, as Interact accepts members from age 12, ensuring continuity within the Rotary family.
2. Sponsoring Rotary clubs are encouraged to facilitate this transition without imposing additional membership barriers on RotaKids alumni, recognizing that participation in the RotaKids programme already constitutes meaningful preparation for Interact.
3. The following framework applies to RotaKids alumni seeking Interact membership:
   a. Direct eligibility: A RotaKid who has completed at least one full level of the Gear of Service has accumulated verified volunteer hours equivalent to or exceeding the volunteer commitment required during a standard Interact aspirant period (based on a reference framework where a completed level represents substantive and sustained engagement equivalent to the preparation expected for Interact membership; specific hourly requirements are defined at District level per Bylaws Art 6.5), and such a member may be considered eligible for direct Interact membership, without a mandatory probationary or aspirant period, at the discretion of the receiving Interact club and its sponsoring Rotary club.
   b. Standard eligibility: A RotaKid who has not completed a full Gear of Service level shall be subject to the standard membership process of the receiving Interact club, consistent with local practice and RI guidelines.

4. The Gear of Service badge carried by the incoming member, together with the RotaKids Programme Graduation Certificate, shall serve as a verifiable record of volunteer hours accumulated, supporting but not replacing the receiving Interact club's assessment of readiness.
5. Nothing in this article shall be construed as mandatory. The final decision on membership eligibility rests with the receiving Interact club and its sponsoring Rotary club, in accordance with the Standard Interact Club Constitution and applicable local regulations.

13.090. RotaKids Citation

To encourage excellence and consistency, the District Governor, in coordination with the District RotaKids Committee, is authorized to issue an annual "RotaKids Citation" to clubs that achieve a set of pre-defined goals in service, leadership development, and transition to Interact. RI encourages the eventual integration of this recognition into the official Rotary Citation framework.

ROTAKIDS GUIDE FOR ROTARY CLUB SPONSORS

1. Why Sponsor a RotaKids Club?

Sponsoring a RotaKids club is a strategic investment in the future of Rotary.

- Member Pipeline: Children who begin at age 6–7 become dedicated Interactors by age 12-13.
- Community Visibility: RotaKids projects attract the attention of parents, local media, and public authorities.
- Club Revitalization: Interaction with the enthusiasm of children brings renewed energy to Rotary members.

2. Choosing an Organizational Model

RotaKids sponsorship may be organized by one Rotary Club or by two or more co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs, subject to District approval. A single Rotary Club may sponsor more than one RotaKids club, especially where several schools or community groups are active in the same locality. Similarly, several Rotary Clubs may jointly sponsor one or more RotaKids clubs where this provides stronger mentorship, continuity, funding, or geographic coverage. In all co-sponsorship models, one lead sponsoring Rotary Club should be designated for certification, reporting, safeguarding coordination, financial oversight, and communication with the District.

Depending on your club's resources, you may choose between two structures:

A. School-Based Model - Most Sustainable

- Partnership: The sponsoring Rotary Club, or a group of co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs, collaborates with a local primary school.
- Location: Meetings are held on school premises.
- Leadership: A volunteer teacher (Faculty Advisor) manages day-to-day activities.
- Key Advantage: Day-to-day child protection procedures are administered through the school's existing protocols, under a formal agreement with the sponsoring Rotary Club. The Rotary Club provides mentorship, vision, and oversight that appropriate safeguards are in place.

B. Community-Based Model - Most Flexible

- Partnership: The sponsoring Rotary Club, or a group of co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs, organizes the group independently (e.g., for children of members or from the local neighborhood).
- Location: The Rotary Club premises or community spaces.
- Leadership: A Rotary member (Rotarian Advisor) coordinates the group.

- Responsibility: The sponsoring Rotary Club and District assume responsibility for safeguarding arrangements, adult supervision, insurance, and legal compliance, in accordance with District standards and the applicable laws of the relevant jurisdiction.

3. Steps to Launch (The 5-Step Launch)

1. Appoint a Committee: Designate a "RotaKids Chairman" within the sponsoring Rotary Club. In a co-sponsorship model, the co-sponsoring Rotary Clubs should designate one lead sponsoring Rotary Club and agree on a common coordination structure. A long-term mandate is recommended for continuity.
2. Identify a Partner: Contact a school administration or organize a community group.
3. Information Session: Present the RotaKids values and Pledge to parents and children.
4. Charter Ceremony: The District issues the Official Charter. The first badges are presented (Solid Wheel - Level I).
5. Register on *RotaKids.net*: Add your club to the world map to be visible and to collaborate with other clubs.

4. Mentorship and the Merit System (The Gear of Service)

The role of the sponsoring club is to guide children through the 3 Levels and 9 milestones of the Gear of Service:

- Encouragement: Attend at least one meeting per month, providing continuity of Rotarian presence and mentorship throughout the member's journey.
- Recognition: Organize formal Wheel Loading Ceremonies for the progressive filling of circle markers on the children's badges, marking each milestone achieved through verified volunteer service.
- Transfer: At the appropriate age, ensure a formal Graduation Ceremony marking the transition from RotaKids to the local Interact club, presenting the RotaKids Programme Graduation Certificate and facilitating continuity within the Rotary family.

5. Funding: The Zero-Fee Model

RotaKids is designed to be accessible to everyone:

- No fees to RI and no mandatory child dues: All resources remain at the local level, and no child may be required or expected to contribute financially.
- Self-Funding: Teach children to organize small fundraising projects (lemonade stands, handmade craft fairs).
- Sponsor Support: The Rotary Club is responsible for covering the cost of member badges (under USD 0.50 per unit). Optionally, the Rotary Club may also contribute to the cost of a standard RotaKids uniform (typically a cap and a T-shirt) or other promotional materials, at its own discretion and according to available resources.

6. Digital Resources

The RotaKids digital infrastructure is offered as a foundational asset developed by the pioneers of District 2241. Its current components have different levels of maturity and are subject to RI-approved technical, privacy, safeguarding, and governance review before any official deployment.

- ROTAKIDS.ORG: Public documentation and resolution-support website, including governance documents, templates, and supporting materials.
- ROTAKIDS.NET: World club registry, currently maintained manually by the current administrator, based on identified and verified clubs.
- ROTAKIDS.COM: PHP/HTML prototype reserved for future project, fundraising, or impact-related tools; not an operational MVP and not an official fundraising platform.
- ROTAKIDS.CLUB: Basic reserved presence for future club-level digital tools; not yet an operational platform.

THE ROTAKIDS GLOBAL HANDBOOK

1. Introduction: The Power of the Young Leader

RotaKids is not merely a volunteering club; it is a character incubator. Between the ages of 6 and 13 (with the standard range being 7 to 12, and a one-year extension in either direction permitted upon approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with applicable local law) children absorb values that will define their entire adult lives. This handbook provides the structure needed to transform children's natural enthusiasm into projects with real impact.

2. The Adult Support Team

A. The Rotarian Advisor: A member of the sponsoring Rotary Club. In a Community-Based club, the Rotarian Advisor is required to attend all meetings. In a School-Based club, the Rotarian Advisor is required to attend at minimum the monthly board meetings. Their role is to bring the "world of Rotary" into the school or community and to facilitate access to resources.
B. The Faculty Advisor: The key person in the School-Based Model. They manage day-to-day logistics, track attendance, and ensure that all activities are age-appropriate. The Faculty Advisor is required to attend all regular membership meetings of a school-based club.

3. RotaKids Meeting Structure (45-Minute Model)

Meetings must be fast, energetic, and structured:

1. Opening (2 min): Official greeting and recitation of the RotaKids Pledge in unison.
2. Minutes (5 min): The RotaKids Secretary reads the notes from the previous meeting.
3. Vision (15 min): Discussion of current projects. *"What have we done? What comes next?"* The Brainstorming method is used.
4. Leadership Activity (15 min): A team game or a short lesson on Rotary values.
5. Closing (3 min): Announcement of the next meeting date and agenda items.

No meeting shall be deemed official unless the Rotarian Advisor is present (Community-Based Model) or the Faculty Advisor is present (School-Based Model).

4. The Service-Learning Methodology

We teach children to plan their projects using 4 simple steps:

- INVESTIGATION: What problem do we see in our school or neighborhood?
- PREPARATION: What do we need? Who can help us?
- ACTION: Carrying out the project itself.
- REFLECTION: What did we learn? How did those we helped feel?

5. Implementing the Merit System (The Gear of Service)

The Gear of Service badge system is the programme's core pedagogical retention tool, providing children with a visible, tangible record of their growth through service:

- Monitoring: The Secretary maintains a "Three Wheels Register" - a record of the volunteer hours and service activities completed by each member, verified and signed by the Rotarian Advisor or Faculty Advisor at each meeting.
- Validation: At the end of each semester, or upon the completion of a major project, the Rotarian Advisor reviews the Three Wheels Register and approves the filling of the next circle marker on the member's badge.
- Solemnity: The Wheel Loading Ceremony - the formal filling of a circle marker on the badge - is strongly recommended to take place before the entire school community or in the presence of parents and invited guests, to reinforce the sense of achievement and shared pride in service.

6. Completing a Minimum of 3 Projects per Year

A RotaKids club must cover all 3 directions. A comprehensive catalogue of 70 project examples across 7 categories is available in Annex B of the RotaKids Resolution Package.

1. School/Local: e.g., creative recycling, a "Friendship Bench" in the school yard, homework help for younger classmates.
2. Regional/National: e.g., the "Purple 4 Polio" campaign (planting crocuses or fundraising), clothing collections for disadvantaged areas.
3. International: e.g., correspondence with another RotaKids club via rotakids.net, the "Shoebox" project for children in other countries, fundraising for animal shelters.

7. Safety and Ethics (Safeguarding Essentials)

- The Golden Rule: Never one adult alone with a child.
- Identity: Children wear the RotaKids uniform or badges during external activities to be easily identifiable.
- Digital: Access to the club website (on the .club domain) is monitored by the Rotarian Advisor and/or Faculty Advisor.

8. The Graduation Ceremony (The Bridge to Interact)

Members who have completed at least one full Gear of Service level - evidenced by the completion of the three Progress Markers of a level and the corresponding formal advancement record - receive direct eligibility for Interact membership upon departure from the RotaKids programme, consistent with Article 13.080 of the RotaKids Statement of Policy. Members who have completed Level III in full also receive the Master of the Gear certificate. All departing members receive the RotaKids Programme Graduation Certificate, regardless of the level reached at the time of departure.

9. The RotaKids Citation (Annual Recognition Mechanism)

Mirroring Rotary International's standards of excellence, the RotaKids Citation is the annual distinction awarded to clubs that meet their strategic objectives. It is not merely an award - it is a club health monitoring tool.

Performance Criteria (Annual Objectives)

To receive the Citation, a RotaKids club must achieve at least 5 of the following 7 objectives during a Rotary year:

1. Values Framework: The RotaKids Pledge is recited at a minimum of 90% of meetings held.
2. Service Impact: Completion of 3 projects (School/Local, Regional/National, and International).
3. The Gear of Service: At least 50% of active members advance by at least one circle marker in the merit system during the Rotary year.
4. Digital Presence: Club data updated on RotaKids.net and at least two success stories published on the club's RotaKids.club page.
5. Membership & Retention: Maintaining a minimum of 15 active members, or a net growth of 10% compared to the previous year.
6. Strategic Pipeline (Transition): At least one member who has reached the upper age limit is formally transferred to a local Interact club through the Graduation Ceremony.
7. Fundraising Impact: Completion of at least one visible Service-Learning fundraising project, reported on RotaKids.com.

Districts may adapt these criteria by adding additional objectives or adjusting the minimum number of objectives required, provided that the core principles of service, membership development, and Rotary values are maintained. Any such adaptation must be approved by the District Governor or the District RotaKids Committee Chair.

10. The Transition Protocol: The Bridge to Interact

RotaKids is the foundation, and its success is also measured by the number of young people who continue within the Rotary family.

1. Identification: At the beginning of each Rotary year, the Secretary identifies members who will reach the upper age limit during that mandate, as well as members who have completed at least one full Gear of Service level and may therefore be eligible for direct Interact membership.
2. Interact Mentorship: The local Interact club (or the nearest available) shall designate an "Interact Ambassador" to visit the RotaKids club and share their experience of Interact projects with the younger members.
3. Graduation Ceremony: At the last meeting of June, all departing members receive the RotaKids Programme Graduation Certificate, documenting their years of service, the levels reached, and the circle markers earned.

Members who have completed at least one full Gear of Service level - evidenced by completion of the three Progress Markers of a level and the corresponding formal

advancement record - are eligible for direct Interact membership, without a mandatory probationary or aspirant period, consistent with Article 13.080 of the RotaKids Statement of Policy.
Members who have completed Level III in full also receive the Master of the Gear certificate, which serves as the highest letter of recommendation for Interact membership.
Members who have not completed any full level are encouraged to transition into Interact through the standard membership process of the receiving club.

11. Using the RotaKids Digital Ecosystem
Unlike other programs, RotaKids benefits from a donated digital infrastructure provided by the pioneers of District 2241.

- RotaKids.net (The Registry): The Rotarian Advisor is responsible for keeping the club's map pin "green" (active). Clubs that report no activity for 24 consecutive months will be marked as "Legacy Clubs" (grey pin).
- RotaKids.org (The Library): The single source for downloading official emblems, charter diploma templates, and parental consent forms.
- RotaKids.club (The Community): Each club claims its own subdomain (e.g., pitesti.rotakids.club). Publishing the full names or contact details of minors is strictly prohibited. The site is administered by the Rotarian Advisor or Faculty Advisor under Safeguarding rules.
- RotaKids.com (The Impact): A PHP/HTML prototype reserved for future project, fundraising, or impact-related tools. It is not an operational MVP and not an official fundraising platform unless and until approved through RI-compatible technical, privacy, safeguarding, and governance review. Clubs use this platform to access support for their Service-Learning activities and to demonstrate the program's collective impact at the global level.

12. Ceremony Guide: "The Wheel Loading Ceremony"
The filling of a Progress Marker on the badge is the supreme moment of pride for a RotaKid.

1. Context: The ceremony takes place at the end of a major project or at the end of a semester.
2. Attendance: The presence of the President of the sponsoring Rotary Club, or the highest-ranking available officer per the order of precedence established in the club's governing documents, is required.
3. The Act: The child is called forward. Their achievement is read aloud - for example: "For 50 hours of volunteer service and coordinating the recycling team."
4. The Symbol: The Advisor fills the corresponding Progress Marker on the badge worn by the child.
   For each Progress Marker filled - at any level - the achievement is acknowledged with the reading of the hours accumulated and a personal word of encouragement from the presiding officer.

At the transition between levels - when the member advances to the next Gear of Service level - the ceremony carries full solemnity. The new badge corresponding to the new level is presented, showing the previously completed level in the Level Markers area and the first Progress Marker of the new level already filled. At the same ceremony, the Level Completion Certificate for the level just completed is presented, and the following message is delivered:

- Transition to Level I (upon joining the club) "You are in the circle - thank you for belonging!"
- Transition to Level II (upon completion of Level I) "You are a spoke of the wheel - thank you for taking action!"
- Transition to Level III (upon completion of Level II) "You are in the gear - thank you for moving others!"

Upon departure from the programme, regardless of the level reached, the member receives the RotaKids Programme Graduation Certificate, documenting their years of service, the levels reached, and the circle markers earned. If the member has completed Level III in full, they also receive the Level III Completion Certificate at the same ceremony. The Graduation Certificate serves as the member's passport into their next chapter - whether Interact, school leadership, or community life.

12.1. The President's Ceremonial Collar

The RotaKids Club President may wear a lightweight ceremonial collar during official club meetings, charter ceremonies, induction ceremonies, Wheel Loading Ceremonies, citation ceremonies, handover ceremonies, and formal public events.

The President's Collar represents temporary service responsibility and club representation during the elected term. It does not represent personal rank or superiority over other members.

The collar shall be simple, child-safe, lightweight, and appropriate for children aged 7 to 12. It may consist of a turquoise or club-color ribbon, a child-safe breakaway clasp, and a central RotaKids or Rotary-family emblem approved by the sponsoring Rotary Club and District.

At the annual handover ceremony, the President's Collar may be transferred from the outgoing RotaKids President to the incoming President, symbolizing continuity of service, responsibility, and leadership within the RotaKids Club.

The President's Collar is optional but recommended for clubs that wish to maintain ceremonial continuity with Interact, Rotaract, and Rotary practice.

Together with the President's Ceremonial Collar, the Club Pennant strengthens ceremonial continuity between RotaKids and the wider Rotary family.

12.2 The Club Pennant

A RotaKids club may use a Club Pennant as an optional ceremonial and friendship item, in continuity with Rotary, Rotaract, and Interact practice.

The Club Pennant may be displayed during official club meetings, charter ceremonies, induction ceremonies, Wheel Loading Ceremonies, handover ceremonies, district events, school partnership events, and formal public presentations.
The pennant may also be exchanged with visiting clubs or partner clubs as a symbol of friendship and shared belonging within the Rotary family.
A standard Club Pennant should normally include the RotaKids logo, the name of the club, the city or locality, and the District number. The name of the sponsoring Rotary Club and the year of chartering may also be included.
The pennant does not indicate rank. Its purpose is ceremonial, representative, and relational. It helps children experience Rotary-family continuity and club identity in a concrete and memorable way.
Where a club receives pennants from other RotaKids clubs, Interact clubs, Rotaract clubs, or Rotary clubs, these may be displayed during meetings or kept as part of the club's historical archive.
The Club Pennant is optional but recommended, especially for clubs that participate in district events, friendship exchanges, or inter-club visits.

12.3 The Club Bell

A RotaKids club may use a Club Bell as an optional ceremonial meeting item, in continuity with Rotary, Rotaract, and Interact practice.
The Club Bell may be used by the RotaKids Club President or presiding child officer to open and close official club meetings, charter ceremonies, induction ceremonies, Wheel Loading Ceremonies, handover ceremonies, district events, and formal public presentations.
The sound of the bell marks attention, order, and respect for the meeting. In RotaKids, the bell should always be explained as a symbol of service responsibility, not authority or superiority.
The bell should be small, safe, lightweight, and appropriate for children aged 7 to 12. It may be placed on the President's table together with the Club Pennant, President's Ceremonial Collar, attendance register, and other ceremonial items.
The Club Bell is optional but recommended, especially for clubs that wish to preserve Rotary-family ceremonial continuity in a child-appropriate form.

ROTAKIDS BRANDING & MERIT GUIDE

1. Core Visual Identity

The RotaKids brand is the bridge between childhood and community service. Its visual identity must be approachable and distinctive, while remaining firmly rooted in the Rotary heritage.

a) Brand Color: Turquoise (PMS 7466C / Hex #00adbb / R0 G173 B187). This color is unique within the Rotary family - it is not used in the Rotary, Interact, or Rotaract logos - symbolizing freshness, energy, and the clarity of purpose that defines every RotaKid.

b) Typography: Open Sans is the official RotaKids typeface, consistent with Rotary International's digital brand standards. For full typography guidelines, refer to Annex A - Visual Identity Style Guide.

2. The Gear of Service Merit System

The Three Wheels system represents the developmental journey of the RotaKids member. Progress is not from "small to large", but from "belonging" to "acting" and, ultimately, to "setting others in motion".

The Gear of Service is reflected through a single badge format using two marker systems: Level Markers and Progress Markers. The color used to fill the circles is at the discretion of the RotaKids club, subject to approval by the sponsoring Rotary Club, consistent with the uniform color guidelines in Annex A.

LEVEL I - THE SOLID WHEEL Philosophy: "You are in the circle" (TO BE / BELONGING)

Significance: The stage of values assimilation. The child learns what it means to belong to a team, to make a pledge, and to show up for others.

Progress Markers (3):

1) First Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the first milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: recitation of the RotaKids Pledge and active participation in the first group activity or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
2) Second Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the second milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: completion of an individual contribution to a club project or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
3) Third Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the third milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: demonstrated consistency - sustained attendance and participation over the defined period or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).

LEVEL II - THE SPOKED WHEEL Philosophy: "You are a spoke" (TO DO / DIRECTION)
Significance: The child now holds a specific role within the mechanism. They learn individual responsibility and the value of coordinated effort.
Progress Markers (3):

1) First Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the first milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: completion of an individual task within a project or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
2) Second Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the second milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: coordination of a small team within a project or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
3) Third Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the third milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: mentoring a new Level I member or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).

LEVEL III - THE COGWHEEL Philosophy: "You are in the gear" (TO MULTIPLY / LEADERSHIP)
Significance: The capacity to move other mechanisms. Final preparation for transition to Interact and lifelong service within the Rotary family.
Progress Markers (3):

1) First Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the first milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: initiating and planning a new project or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
2) Second Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the second milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: collaboration with the sponsoring Rotary Club or local authorities on a project or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).
3) Third Progress Marker: Awarded upon meeting the third milestone defined by the District RotaKids Committee (example: full completion of Level III requirements - the Master Gear milestone or accumulation of the minimum volunteer hours defined by the District for this milestone).

Each District RotaKids Committee is responsible for establishing the specific requirements for each Progress Marker within its jurisdiction, whether defined as a minimum number of volunteer hours, a specific type of activity, or a combination of both. These requirements shall be documented in the District's supplementary internal regulations and communicated clearly to all sponsoring clubs.
Within the framework established by the District, each RotaKids club retains the flexibility to adapt the path to each milestone to its local context. If a member has not had the opportunity to complete a specific type of activity required for a milestone, due to

circumstances beyond their control, the club, with the approval of the Rotarian Advisor and the sponsoring Rotary Club, may substitute an equivalent activity or volunteer hours, provided the spirit and educational objectives of the level are maintained.
No member shall be permanently blocked from advancing due to the unavailability of a specific activity type. The Gear of Service is a developmental framework, not a rigid checklist. The Gear of Service is a developmental framework designed to encourage steady growth through service; it must never be applied as a rigid or punitive competition between children.

3. Physical Badge Specifications
To ensure global accessibility and a zero cost barrier, this guide encourages local production of badges using readily available materials:

- Badge Format: Circular disc, diameter at the discretion of the club, ensuring all graphic elements remain clearly legible. As a general guideline, 38mm is recommended for everyday wear and 58mm for outdoor activities and events.
- Fastening System: Safety pin (standard) or magnetic clasp (optional, recommended where pin safety is a concern for younger members).
- Marker Systems: Each badge contains two sets of circle positions: three Level Markers at 9 o'clock and three Progress Markers at 3 o'clock. Clubs are encouraged to use any locally available, low-cost material to fill the circle positions on the badge - including self-adhesive rhinestone crystals, colored stickers, enamel paint, or equivalent materials. No specific material is mandated globally. The estimated cost per badge unit should remain under USD 0.50, allowing any club in the world to implement the system without subsidies.
- Design Files: Digital templates for badge production are available for download at rotakids.org following the adoption of this resolution.

4. Brand Protection & Digital Assets
The transfer of digital assets to Rotary International ensures that:

1. rotakids.net - Remains the official global registry of verified RotaKids clubs.
2. rotakids.org - Serves as the central library for this guide and all programme handbooks and templates.
3. rotakids.com - Provides the global fundraising and awareness platform for projects, materials, and resources.
4. rotakids.club - Provides each new club with a standardized digital identity, protecting the brand from unauthorized use on external platforms.

DISTRICT-LED SAFEGUARDING & CHILD PROTECTION FRAMEWORK

1. Statement of Principles

Rotary International is committed to creating and maintaining a safe environment for all young people participating in its activities. For the RotaKids segment - children aged 7 to 12, with a one-year extension in either direction permitted upon approval of the sponsoring Rotary Club and in accordance with applicable local law - safety is the absolute priority. This framework ensures compliance with the national legislation specific to each jurisdiction.

2. The Decentralized Accountability Model (The Shield)

To eliminate legal risks at the global level (Evanston), the RotaKids program operates under the following delegation of responsibility:

- RI's Role: Provides brand authorization (Turquoise, PMS 7466C / Hex #00adbb), the educational framework, and general ethical standards.
- The District's Role: Is the legal authority responsible for implementing and monitoring compliance with local child protection laws (e.g., GDPR in the EU, COPPA in the USA).
- The Sponsor Club's Role: Directly executes safety protocols at every meeting or event.

3. Safety Protocols by Organizational Model

A. School-Based Model

- Delegation of Responsibility: Legal responsibility for the physical and digital safety of minors rests with the educational institution.
- Supervision: At least one Faculty Advisor must be present at every RotaKids activity.
- Standards: The child protection policy of the respective school applies, already approved by the Ministry of Education of the host country.

B. Community-Based Model

- Responsibility: Rests exclusively with the sponsoring Rotary Club.
- Adult Screening: Any Rotarian who interacts directly with RotaKids members must present a valid criminal background check certificate and complete the volunteer screening procedure established by the District.
- The Golden Rule (2-Adult Rule): No adult may be alone with a RotaKid at any time. Every activity requires the presence of at least two verified adults.

4. Data Protection and Digital Identity

In the context of the domain transfer to RI, the following digital protocols apply:

- Local Storage: Member data (name, age, parental contact details) shall NOT be stored on central RI servers. They remain in the secure physical or digital registers of the District or School.

- Public Image: Photographs of RotaKids members may be published on rotakids.net or rotakids.club only with the written consent (consent form) of parents or legal guardians, using the standard template included in this handbook.
- Prohibited: Display of a minor's home address or any direct contact details on public platforms. Success stories submitted for Citation Criterion 4 may utilize group photos without identifiable faces (e.g., hands only, backs of heads, or blurred faces) or generic project imagery if explicit parental consent for online publication has not been secured.

5. Incident Procedure

Any suspected breach of child safety must be reported within 24 hours to:

1. The District Youth Protection Officer.
2. The relevant local legal authorities.
3. The District Governor.

Note: RI receives only annual statistical compliance reports - not the details of individual cases - in order to avoid direct legal liability.

6. Mentor Identification

The official Turquoise color (PMS 7466C / Hex #00adbb) shall be used on all mentor badges and safety materials to visually identify adult persons who have completed the verification process (background check).

THE 2026 RESOLUTION POSITION PAPER

1. Executive Summary: The Urgency of 2026

For more than fifteen years, the RotaKids movement has grown organically from the grassroots level, developing into a global network of verified clubs serving tens of thousands of young leaders across more than twenty countries. Despite this sustained success, the program continues to operate in an institutional grey area, without an officially protected brand identity under Rotary International.

The 2026 Resolution is not a simple request for recognition. It is a complete package solution that directly addresses RI's longstanding concerns regarding legal liability, while simultaneously offering a fully operational digital infrastructure - at zero cost to RI.

2. Historical Analysis: Why Previous Resolutions Failed - And Why 2026 Is Different

A structured review of resolutions submitted between 2014 and 2025 reveals a consistent pattern of two blocking factors:

Factor 1 - Liability Fear: RI Evanston consistently resisted proposals that implied global management responsibility for children under 12, given the complex and varying child protection legislation across 220 countries and territories.

Factor 2 - Lack of Standardization: Previous proposals were fragmented under different names - "Rotary Kids", "EarlyAct", "RotaKids" - with no unified governance framework.

Year / Code	Proposed Name	Result	Primary RI Board Argument
COL 2016	RotaKids	Rejected	Districts already have total freedom to organize locally without RI oversight
17R-18	EarlyAct	Rejected (221 Yes / 262 No)	Policy already allows clubs to sponsor youth activities without formal RI status
17R-19	Rotary Kids	Rejected (200 Yes / 281 No)	Recognition would create unnecessary administrative layers for a local program
18R-23	EarlyAct	Rejected (192 Yes / 301 No)	Current policies already allow youth work without formal recognition
18R-24	Rotary Kids	Rejected (182 Yes / 312 No)	Administrative burden and Child Protection risks exceed benefits
19R-14	RotaKids	Rejected (191 Yes / 286 No)	Board suggested focus on existing programs;
20R-08	Clubs for children aged 6–12	Rejected (185 Yes / 266 No)	Lack of standardized global safeguarding infrastructure for this age group
20R-09	Clubs for children under 12 (district-named)	Rejected (122 Yes / 332 No)	Districts should retain flexibility to name and organize locally

21R-15	Rotary Kids (Structured)	Rejected (181 Yes / 295 No)	RI prefers maintaining the flexibility of the "District-Recognized" status
23R-03	Ad hoc committee for children < 12	Rejected (206 Yes / 209 No)	Failed by only 3 votes; Board claimed a committee was not yet necessary
23R-04	Rotary Kids	Rejected (182 Yes / 238 No)	Management should remain at District level (reaffirmed 2018)
24R-12	Ad hoc committee for children < 12	Rejected (141 Yes / 310 No)	A dedicated committee was not considered necessary at this time
24R-13	Rotary Kids	Rejected (165 Yes / 287 No)	Standardized branding should not imply global administrative control or liability
24R-14	Rotary activity groups for children under 12	Rejected (138 Yes / 313 No)	Restricting membership to children of Rotarians conflicts with Rotary's inclusive values
25R-17	Rotary Kids	Rejected (200 Yes / 248 No)	Support for the age group is high, but administrative costs remain a barrier

The 2026 Pivot: The resolution before the Council on Resolutions proposes a "Light Recognition" model that resolves both blocking factors simultaneously. Rotary International provides brand authorization; Districts and sponsoring Rotary Clubs provide the legal, safeguarding, and operational framework; District 2241 offers the existing digital infrastructure for transfer, licensing, or designated stewardship under terms acceptable to RI. The model is designed to avoid new legal, financial, or administrative liability for RI.

3. The Three Strategic Pillars

A. The Leadership Pipeline

Rotary's long-term membership sustainability depends on a continuous pipeline of service-oriented young people. Data from District 2241 - where RotaKids has operated continuously since 2013 - indicates that more than 60% of RotaKids members make a natural transition into Interact upon reaching the upper age limit *(based on D2241 internal tracking data, 2013–2024; district-level data from other pioneering districts available upon request).*

Without an officially recognized RotaKids program, Rotary loses contact with children during their most formative years - leaving this generation to other youth organizations (Lions Cubs, Scouts, Kiwanis K-Kids) that do not share Rotary's values or pipeline.

B. A Unique and Protected Brand Identity

The RotaKids visual identity, built around a distinctive Turquoise color (PMS 7466C / Hex #00adbb) unique within the Rotary family, separates the program visually from Interact and Rotaract, while keeping the Rotary wheel at its center. The innovative three-stage progression system (TO BE → TO DO → TO MULTIPLY) provides a structured developmental framework that no competing youth organization currently offers.

C. The Digital Infrastructure Offer

District 2241 is not merely proposing a policy - it is offering an existing, decade-old digital infrastructure that may be transferred, licensed, or placed under designated stewardship under terms acceptable to RI. This offer eliminates the need for brand acquisition or initial domain development from day one, while recognizing that some components are functional, some are manually administered, and some remain prototype or placeholder interfaces requiring RI-approved technical, safeguarding, privacy, and governance review before any official deployment.

Domain Registration Timeline (Proof of Stewardship)

Domain	Purpose	Registered
RotaKids.ro	*District 2241 origin*	*2012-11-12*
RotaKids.com	Future impact / fundraising prototype	2013-04-23
RotaKids.net	World club registry	2016-04-04
RotaKids.org	Resources & governance library	2018-07-16
RotaKids.club	Future club tools / basic reserved presence	2022-02-03
RotaryKids.com/.net/.org	Brand protection (generic)	2026-04-08

1. The generic RotaryKids.com/.net/.org domains were registered in April 2026 as a deliberate brand protection measure, completing the ecosystem ahead of the Council on Resolutions vote. Their recent registration does not diminish the fourteen-year stewardship of the core RotaKids infrastructure - it demonstrates continued proactive commitment to protecting the brand on behalf of Rotary International.
2. For clarity, the current status of the infrastructure is mixed: rotakids.org functions primarily as a public documentation and resolution-support website; rotakids.net functions as a registry maintained manually by the current administrator; rotakids.com is a PHP/HTML prototype and not an MVP fundraising or operational platform; rotakids.club is currently a basic presence. These limitations are disclosed in order to distinguish between domain/infrastructure value and production-readiness.

4. Global Landscape and Statistics (April 2026)

RotaKids has become the de facto global standard for the 7–12 age segment.

Program	Verified Clubs (rotakids.net)	Estimated Total*	Est. Members	Growth 2021–26	Key Regions
RotaKids	250+	800–1,000	~25,000	+40%	UK, Romania, Australia, India, South Africa
EarlyAct	15	550–650	~14,000	+10%	USA, Philippines, Canada
Rotary Kids	30	200–250	~5,000	Stationary	Brazil, Mexico, Germany

**Estimated totals are based on a database built over multiple years through systematic internet research and manual verification by the District 2241 RotaKids team. The rotakids.net registry reflects clubs individually identified and verified through this process; it does not rely on self-registration or district reporting. Official centralized data collection, enabled by the proposed recognition, would allow this baseline to be expanded and maintained globally.*

Competitive Landscape: RotaKids vs. Peer Organizations

Program	Parent Organization	Age Range	Est. Clubs	Est. Members	Annual Fee	Model
RotaKids	Rotary (unofficial)	7–12	800 – 1,000	~25,000	Zero	District-led
K-Kids	Kiwanis International	6–12	~1,100	~22,000	$235 / club / y.	Centralized
Leo Cubs	Lions International	0–12	undefined	undefined	Variable	Family-based
EarlyAct	Rotary (unofficial)	5–13	~600	~14,000	Zero	District-led

The data above reveals a critical strategic reality: Kiwanis charges $235 per club per year for K-Kids, yet RotaKids has grown at 40% over five years with no RI dues, no mandatory child fees, and no central administrative structure. Official recognition is not expected to create a substantial financial burden for Rotary International; it will legitimize what already exists. A further distinction: K-Kids membership is tied to family affiliation with a Kiwanis member. RotaKids is open to any child in any school or community, regardless of parental affiliation. This inclusivity is not incidental - it is the program's greatest competitive strength, and it is fully consistent with Rotary International's own values of diversity and openness.

5. Addressing Rotary International Key Concerns

5.1 Legal Liability The District-Led model is the definitive answer to RI's historical liability concern. The resolution explicitly states that Rotary International shall not be legally or financially liable for RotaKids club activities. Responsibility rests with the sponsoring Rotary Club and the District, in accordance with local law and any formal agreement with a host school or community partner.

5.2 Child Protection The accompanying Safeguarding Framework (Document 7) establishes a decentralized accountability model that mirrors existing Interact standards, adapted for the younger age group. School-based clubs operate under the host school's existing child protection protocols; community-based clubs operate under District-level screening and the mandatory 2-Adult Rule.

5.3 Relationship with Existing GB&I Clubs The RotaKids program was pioneered in Great Britain and Ireland, and the GB&I network represents the largest and most established RotaKids community in the world. The 2026 Resolution does not require existing GB&I clubs to re-charter or modify their current operations. Recognition by RI would grandfather all existing chartered clubs, providing them with an official brand identity while preserving their

established governance structures. This resolution is designed to elevate what RIBI built - not to replace it.

5.4 Administrative Burden Unlike Interact, which is a Structured Program with direct Rotary International administrative involvement, RotaKids is proposed as a District-Led Program. RI's role is limited to brand authorization and to any digital infrastructure stewardship arrangement it chooses to accept or designate. No new RI staff, budget lines, or administrative structures are anticipated.

5.5 Precedent: The Rotarian Action Group Model

RotaKids is not asking Rotary International to invent a new framework. The "light recognition" model proposed in this resolution already exists within RI's own structure, in the form of Rotarian Action Groups (RAGs).

RAGs are officially recognized by RI without RI assuming direct legal liability, administrative control, or financial responsibility for their activities. They operate independently, under their own governance, with RI providing only brand authorization and visibility. This is precisely the model proposed for RotaKids.

The Council on Resolutions is not being asked to take a leap of faith. It is being asked to apply an existing, proven framework to a new and younger audience.

5.6 A Proposed Pilot Framework: Built-In Accountability

To address any remaining concerns about long-term commitment, District 2241 proposes that the initial recognition be structured as a three-year pilot program, subject to evaluation by the RI Board at the end of the pilot period.

Suggested evaluation criteria:

- A minimum 20% increase in the number of verified RotaKids clubs registered globally.
- Submission of at least one Safeguarding compliance report per District operating a RotaKids program.
- Zero legal liability incidents attributable to RI as a result of the recognition.

If these criteria are not met, the RI Board retains full authority to withdraw recognition at the conclusion of the pilot period. This sunset clause is not a weakness - it is a demonstration of confidence. District 2241 is certain the program will exceed these thresholds. We offer the exit door because we know it will never need to be used.

6. Conclusion: A Vote for the Future of Rotary

Rejecting recognition will not stop RotaKids from growing - it will simply leave it without coordination, brand protection, or institutional legitimacy. By adopting the 2026 Resolution, the Council on Resolutions does not hand Rotary International a burden. It hands Rotary International a future.

The pioneers of District 2241, building on the foundation laid by Great Britain and Ireland, have spent fourteen years constructing the house, securing the perimeter, and developing the tools. They now offer the keys, freely and unconditionally, to Rotary International.
In 2023, resolution 23R-03 (a modest request to merely appoint an ad hoc committee to examine the need for a program for children under 12) failed by three votes: 206 in favor, 209 against. Three votes separated Rotary International from beginning a conversation that this movement has been requesting for over a decade.

The 2026 Resolution does not ask for a committee. It delivers the answer. The infrastructure is built, the framework is tested, the legal model is sound, and the children are waiting. We are not three votes away from history - we are one vote away from it.

It is time to let the children in.